[Metric]
A-A-135C
September 18, 1997
Superseding
A-A-135B
April 22, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
OPENER, LETTER, HAND
(METAL)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description by all Federal Agencies.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers metal, hand held letter openers for general office use.

2. Salient Characteristics:

2.1 The opener shall be fabricated from case hardened, through hardened, or stainless steel; or, any commercially appropriate, corrosion resistant metal in either a straight or offset blade, similar to Figures 1 and 2 in section 6.3.

2.2. All corners, including the handle end shall be smoothly rounded and shall have an overall length of 228.6 mm ± 12.7 mm (9 ± 1/2 inches) long: 152.4 mm ± 6.35 mm (6 ± 1/4 inches) for the blade and 76.20 mm ± 6.35 mm (3 ± 1/4 inches) for the handle.

2.3 The blade shall be of uniform width or slightly tapered from 9.53 mm (3/8-in) maximum to 4.76 mm (3/16-in) minimum starting from the blade handle to a point 25.4 mm (1-in) from the tip.

2.4 The blade shall be tapered from a point 25.4 mm ± 6.35 mm (1 ± 1/4 inches) from the blade tip, and have a straight blade not less than 1.59 mm (1/16-inch) thick. The blade shall be beveled on both edges, but not sharpened, to permit envelopes to be slit without tearing.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Branch (2FYEE), 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7520

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2.5 The handle shall be 19.05 mm ± 1.40 mm (3/4 ± 1/8 inches) wide, if straight, or, if tapered from a maximum 22.22 mm (7/8-inch) at the handle end to a minimum 12.70 mm (1/2-inch) wide at the blade-handle junction, it shall have a handle that is either flat or decorative. If flat, handle shall be no less than 1.60 mm (1/16-inch) thick; and if decorative, no more than 12.70 mm (1/2-inch) thick. Note: If handles are decorative, they shall be made of plastic, hard rubber, metal, bone or wood. Decorative handles shall be affixed to the blade so as not be become loose with use, causing the blade to twist or fall off.

2.6 Workmanship: The letter openers shall be free of any defects which may adversely affect the appearance, impair serviceability or which may present a personal hazard to the user, including, but not limited to, superfluous coating of any kind, burrs, niches, scratches, discoloration or rough or sharp edges.

2.7 Corrosion Resistance: The entire letter opener (if fabricated from metal) or the blade (if designed with a decorative handle) shall be either corrosion resistant stainless steel or anodized, plated, finished with baked enamel. The contractor shall provide a manufacturer's chemical certification of corrosion resistance upon request by the Government.

3. Regulatory Requirements: The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practical, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

4. Quality Assurance Provisions:

4.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5. Packaging: Packaging, packing, palletization and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

6. Notes:

6.1 Source of Documents. The following documents form a part of the Commercial Item Description to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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6.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

6.2 **National Stock Number Listing (NSN).** The following is an NSN assigned which corresponds to this CID. The cited NSN may not be indicative of all possible NSN's associated with the CID.

7520-00-240-4841

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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6.3 Figures 1 and 2:

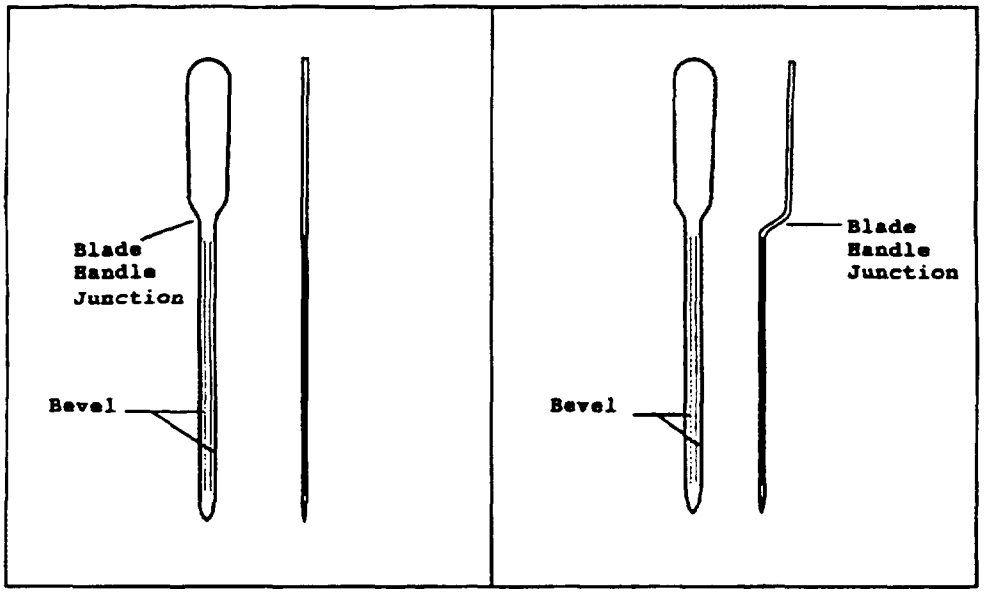


Figure 1

Figure 2

Figures are provided to depict blade and handle configuration, but are not intended to be restrictive.

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